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UPSC Intel · Daily Brief

FRIDAY, 02 OCTOBER 2026

21 must-know stories, 24 Prelims facts, 15 editorials and 12 explainers, picked from 723 stories reported. Each item links to its source; notes quote the reports.

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MUST-KNOW

High-yield stories: make notes on these. Grouped by syllabus area.

Polity & Constitution

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Gujarat UCC Bill gets President Murmu’s assent, becomes 2nd state after Uttarakhand

President Droupadi Murmu gave her assent to the Gujarat Uniform Civil Code (UCC) Bill, 2026, making Gujarat the second state after Uttarakhand to codify a common set of personal laws. The legislation was passed after an eight-hour debate on March 24, 2026, following the submission of a report by a panel headed by retired Supreme Court judge Justice Ranjana Prakash Desai. Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel stated that the Bill aims to ensure social harmony, national unity, women's empowerment, and to safeguard the rights and dignity of daughters. The legislation explicitly exempts the state's Scheduled Tribe (ST) population from its purview. Opposition parties including the Congress and AAP termed the legislation anti-Muslim and requested it be referred to a select committee, a charge rejected by the government. Key provisions include compulsory marriage registration within 60 days with a fine up to Rs. 10,000, prohibition of polygamy, bigamy, triple talaq, and nikah halala. The law mandates court approval for divorce, grants equal property rights to sons and daughters, and requires registration for live-in relationships alongside maintenance rights for deserted women.

When: 2026-10-02 · **Where:** Gujarat · **Who:** President Droupadi Murmu, Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel, Justice Ranjana Prakash Desai · **Prelims:** Gujarat is the second state after Uttarakhand to enact a comprehensive UCC.; The drafting panel was headed by retired Supreme Court judge Justice Ranjana Prakash Desai.; The Gujarat UCC Bill exempts the state's Scheduled Tribe (ST) population.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Represents a major policy implementation of the BJP's core agenda alongside Ram Mandir and Article 370 abrogation.; Standardizes civil matters such as marriage, divorce, and inheritance across communities while exempting Scheduled Tribes.*

Static — Article 44 of the Indian Constitution, under the Directive Principles of State Policy, states that the State shall endeavour to secure for the citizens a uniform civil code throughout the territory of India. A Uniform Civil Code aims to replace personal laws based on scriptures and customs of each religious community with a common set governing marriage, divorce, inheritance, and adoption. Goa has historically been governed by the pre-independence Portuguese Civil Code of 1867, making it distinct from modern legislative UCC enactments.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Act/Bill/Rules

Hindustan Times: read the source · also reported by NDTV, Times of India

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court says state can set National Song, but cannot impose conscientious objectors to penal action

The Supreme Court sought a response from the Union government on a petition filed by T.M. Krishna. The court sought a response from the Union government on a petition filed by renowned Carnatic vocalist and author T.M. Krishna challenging the Prevention of Insults to National Honour (Amendment) Act, 2026

When: 2026-10-02 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Supreme Court of India, T.M. Krishna, Union Government · **Prelims:** Petitioner: T.M. Krishna, a renowned Carnatic vocalist and author.; Legislation in question: Prevention of Insults to National Honour (Amendment) Act, 2026.; Court involved: Supreme Court of India.

> ***Why it matters —*** *It addresses the crucial intersection between statutory mandates for national symbols and individual fundamental freedoms.; It tests the limits of state authority in enforcing participation in patriotic exercises.*

Static — Article 19(1)(a) of the Constitution guarantees the freedom of speech and expression, which includes the right to remain silent in certain contexts. Article 25 guarantees the freedom of conscience and free profession, practice, and propagation of religion. The Supreme Court in the landmark Bijoe Emmanuel v. State of Kerala (1986) case protected students who refused to sing the National Anthem due to religious beliefs.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, History, Art & Culture · Prelims angle: Judgment, Act/Bill/Rules

The Hindu: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Justice Nagarathna started drafting judgment; Nine-judge bench verdict expected this month

The Supreme Court's nine-judge Constitution Bench is expected to deliver its verdict this month on matters of faith, including women's entry into Sabarimala. Justice B.V. Nagarathna, the only female judge on the bench, has reportedly begun drafting her judgment on the matter. During the hearings, Justice Nagarathna observed that genuine female devotees aged between 10 and 50 would stay at home rather than visit Sabarimala. Other judges on the bench may draft their opinions individually or collectively, with the majority verdict ultimately prevailing. The nine-judge bench reserved its verdict on May 14 after conducting 16 days of hearings covering seven issues related to religious freedom, rights, and practices. The hearings also covered petitions challenging practices such as female genital mutilation in the Dawoodi Bohra community and temple entry bans for Parsi women marrying outside. The proceedings addressed core arguments on whether menstruation acts as a prohibition when viewed from the perspective of the devotee.

When: May 14 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Justice B.V. Nagarathna · **Prelims:** The nine-judge bench heard arguments over 16 days.; The verdict was reserved on May 14.; Justice B.V. Nagarathna is the sole female judge on the nine-judge bench.

> ***Why it matters —*** *It addresses the complex interplay between constitutional rights to equality and freedom of religion.; The ruling will provide clarity on essential religious practices and the extent of judicial review over matters of faith.*

Static — A Constitution Bench of the Supreme Court of India consists of at least five judges sitting for the purpose of deciding any case involving a substantial question of law as to the interpretation of the Constitution. Article 145(3) of the Constitution of India mandates that cases involving substantial questions of law regarding constitutional interpretation must be heard by a bench of minimum five judges. Under Article 142, the Supreme Court has the inherent power to pass decrees or orders necessary for doing complete justice in any pending cause or matter.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

keralakaumudi.com: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

SC declines One Nation One Election panel's proposal to interact with CJI Kant, others

The Supreme Court administration declined a parliamentary committee's proposal to hold an informal discussion with the CJI and sitting judges on simultaneous elections. The Supreme Court secretary general informed the joint committee that discussing the proposed constitutional amendments on the administrative side was not expedient or desirable. The refusal was based on the ground that the proposed amendments could eventually become the subject of judicial review before the Supreme Court. The decision followed consultations between CJI Surya Kant and senior judges, after which the proposed interaction scheduled for October 6 was cancelled. Joint committee chairman PP Chaudhary stated that the visit was put off because committee members' dates did not match and due to his other commitments. Independent Rajya Sabha member and senior advocate Kapil Sibal had earlier publicly objected to the proposed visit, calling it unconstitutional and violating the separation of powers. The joint committee is examining the Constitution (One Hundred and Twenty-Ninth Amendment) Bill, 2024 and the Union Territories Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2024. The bills propose inserting Article 82A and amending Articles 83, 172, and 327 to facilitate simultaneous Lok Sabha and state assembly elections.

When: 2026-10-02 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** CJI Surya Kant, PP Chaudhary, Kapil Sibal · **Prelims:** The parliamentary joint committee is examining the Constitution (One Hundred and Twenty-Ninth Amendment) Bill, 2024.; The proposed amendment seeks to insert a new Article 82A dealing with simultaneous elections.; The joint committee is headed by BJP member PP Chaudhary.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Upholds the principle of separation of powers between the judiciary and the legislature.; Prevents potential conflicts of interest where judges adjudicate on laws they have previously discussed administratively.*

Static — The doctrine of separation of powers ensures the independence of the judiciary from the executive and the legislature under the Indian Constitution. Judicial review is a basic feature of the Indian Constitution, allowing courts to examine the constitutional validity of legislative enactments and constitutional amendments. Parliamentary committees are panels of MPs constituted to scrutinize bills, budgets, and policies in detail before they are debated and voted on in Parliament.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution

Hindustan Times: read the source · also reported by NDTV

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court Declares Tribunal Reforms Ordinance Unconstitutional Due to Violation of Separation of Powers. Legislative Provisions Undermine Judicial Independence and Contradict Established Judicial Principles.

The Supreme Court delivered its ruling striking down the Tribunal Reforms Ordinance. The Supreme Court declared the Tribunal Reforms Ordinance unconstitutional because its legislative provisions violated the separation of powers and undermined judicial independence.

When: 2026-10-02 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Supreme Court · **Prelims:** The Supreme Court declared the Tribunal Reforms Ordinance unconstitutional.; The grounds for striking down the ordinance included violation of the separation of powers.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reaffirms the doctrine of separation of powers as a core pillar of India's constitutional democracy.; Protects judicial independence by striking down executive or legislative interference in tribunal appointments.*

Static — Tribunals in India were established under Articles 323A and 323B of the Constitution, inserted by the 42nd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1976. Article 323A deals with administrative tribunals, while Article 323B deals with tribunals for other matters such as taxation and foreign exchange. The Supreme Court has repeatedly emphasized that tribunals must maintain functional independence from the executive branch.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment, Act/Bill/Rules

Lawtext: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

SUPREME COURT GRANTS ANTICIPATORY BAIL TO SHAJAN SKARIA; MERE KNOWLEDGE OF CASTE INSUFFICIENT TO ATTRACT SECTION 3(1)(r) OF SC/ST ACT

The Supreme Court delivered its ruling on an anticipatory bail plea filed by Shajan Skaria. The Supreme Court granted anticipatory bail to Shajan Skaria, ruling that mere knowledge of a person's caste is not enough to invoke Section 3(1)(r) of the SC/ST Act.

When: 2026-10-02 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Shajan Skaria, Supreme Court of India · **Prelims:** The case involves Section 3(1)(r) of the SC/ST Act.; The Supreme Court granted anticipatory bail to Shajan Skaria.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Clarifies the strict legal threshold required to invoke offenses under the SC/ST Act.; Protects against the overbroad application of stringent special penal provisions without requisite intent.*

Static — The Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act was enacted in 1989 to prevent atrocities against members of SCs and STs. Section 3 of the Act defines various offenses of atrocities and prescribes punishments for acts such as public humiliation, wrongful occupation of land, and sexual exploitation. Section 3(1)(r) specifically penalizes intentional insult or intimidation with intent to humiliate a member of a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe in any place within public view.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Social Justice & Welfare, Society · Prelims angle: Judgment

AIMA Media: read the source

International Relations

GS2 MAKE NOTES

India-Canada trade target: $70 billion in five years as CEPA talks speed up

Canada and India are aiming to scale their bilateral trade from USD 30 billion to USD 70 billion over the next five years. Canadian International Trade Minister Maninder Sidhu announced the target at the 2026 G20 Trade Ministers Meeting in Milwaukee. Negotiations for a Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement are being fast-tracked, with the fifth round scheduled in Ottawa. Union Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal and Maninder Sidhu concluded the fourth round of talks in Mumbai. Canada is currently the largest collective investor in India, with over USD 100 billion invested in various infrastructure projects. Energy and critical minerals form the cornerstone of the strategic economic alignment between the two nations. Bilateral trade between India and Canada stood at around USD 8 billion in FY 2025-26, according to the Commerce Ministry.

When: 2026-10-02 · **Where:** Ottawa, Milwaukee, Mumbai · **Who:** Maninder Sidhu, Piyush Goyal, Mark Carney, Narendra Modi · **Prelims:** The bilateral trade target set by Canada and India is USD 70 billion over five years.; Bilateral trade between India and Canada stood at around USD 8 billion in FY 2025-26.; Canada is the largest collective investor in India with over USD 100 billion invested.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Enhances bilateral economic cooperation and supply chain diversification for critical minerals and energy.; Opens new investment avenues for Indian investors in Canadian mining and energy sectors.*

Static — A Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement is a comprehensive free trade agreement that covers negotiation of trade in services, investment, and other areas of economic partnership. Bilateral trade agreements aim to reduce or eliminate tariffs and non-tariff barriers to boost cross-border commerce between partner nations. Critical minerals like lithium, cobalt, and nickel are vital for clean energy technologies, electric vehicles, and advanced electronics manufacturing.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations, Economy, Infrastructure & Energy · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU

Economic Times: read the source · *free copy on msn.com*

GS2 MAKE NOTES

PM Modi’s Indonesia visit yields 20 outcomes, including cooperation on BrahMos missile systems

Prime Minister Narendra Modi visited Indonesia and announced 20 major outcomes to deepen the Comprehensive Strategic Partnership. The outcomes include 14 MoUs and agreements alongside six major announcements covering defence, technology, space, healthcare, and critical minerals. Bilateral talks were held with Indonesian President Prabowo Subianto at the Istana Merdeka in Jakarta. Defence cooperation highlights include collaboration on the BrahMos missile system and an Air-to-Air Missile Cooperation Agreement. IIM Bangalore will establish an overseas campus at the Singhasari Special Economic Zone in Indonesia. India will supply 100 tonnes of DWR-162 wheat seeds to support Indonesia's food security. SAIL and PT Krakatau Steel will form a strategic joint venture for a stainless-steel slab manufacturing facility in Indonesia. India's Unified Payments Interface (UPI) will soon be integrated with Indonesia's payment system. India will assist in the conservation and restoration of the UNESCO-listed Prambanan Temple Complex in Yogyakarta.

When: 2026-10-02 · **Where:** Jakarta and Yogyakarta, Indonesia · **Who:** Prime Minister Narendra Modi and President Prabowo Subianto · **Prelims:** India agreed to supply 100 tonnes of DWR-162 wheat seeds to Indonesia.; IIM Bangalore is set to establish an overseas campus at the

Singhasari Special Economic Zone.; The ECI and Indonesia's General Elections Commission signed an MoU on electoral cooperation.

Why it matters — *Strengthens India's Act East Policy and reinforces ASEAN Centrality in the Indo-Pacific region.; Expands defence exports and strategic industrial collaboration, including BrahMos missile cooperation.*

Static — India and Indonesia established a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership in 2018 during PM Modi's visit to Jakarta. BrahMos is a supersonic cruise missile jointly developed by India (DRDO) and Russia (NPOM). Prambanan Temple Complex in Yogyakarta, Indonesia, is a 9th-century Hindu temple compound designated as a UNESCO World Heritage site.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations, Defence

ddnews.gov.in: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

India Eyes Permanent Seat At High Table Of Un Security Council

India is actively campaigning for both a permanent and a non-permanent seat on the United Nations Security Council. Foreign Affairs Minister S Jaishankar has initiated the campaign for a non-permanent seat during the UN meeting in New York. India faces competition from Tajikistan for the Asia-Pacific non-permanent seat, with Tajikistan backed by the Organisation of Islamic Cooperation. Securing a permanent seat requires reforming the UN structure, which involves unanimous consent and is progressing slowly. India has pursued a permanent seat for the past 30 years as part of its foreign policy to reflect 21st-century realities. Reform challenges include disagreements over the number of new seats and whether new permanent members should hold veto power. India is open to a proposal that initially excludes veto rights for new permanent members to ease current members' concerns. India's bid is supported by the G-4 nations, the African Union, Fiji, the United States, Austria, and Sri Lanka.

When: 2026-10-02 · **Where:** New York, USA · **Who:** S Jaishankar, External Affairs Minister · **Prelims:** Tajikistan is vying against India for the Asia-Pacific non-permanent seat on the UNSC.; Tajikistan has received support from the Organisation of Islamic Cooperation.; Nations supporting India's bid include Fiji, the United States, Austria, and Sri Lanka.

Why it matters — *Highlights India's growing strategic ambition and diplomatic push for inclusive global governance structures.; Tests India's bilateral and multilateral outreach across the Global South, Western partners, and regional blocs like the OIC.*

Static — The United Nations Security Council (UNSC) is one of the six principal organs of the UN, tasked with maintaining international peace and security. The UNSC consists of 15 members: five permanent members (US, UK, France, Russia, China) with veto power, and ten non-permanent members elected for two-year terms. Inter-Governmental Negotiations (IGN) is the UN General Assembly mechanism used by member states to discuss reforms of the Security Council.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations

dailypioneer.com: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

PM Modi, Takaichi deepen India-Japan cooperation across defence, technology, energy and trade

Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Japanese Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi unveiled an ambitious roadmap to strengthen their Special Strategic and Global Partnership following the 16th India-Japan Annual Summit in New Delhi. The two leaders agreed to deepen bilateral cooperation across three priority pillars: defence and security, economic partnership and energy resilience, and stronger people-to-people exchanges. The core issue centers on advancing a free, open, resilient, and prosperous Indo-Pacific amid an increasingly uncertain global geopolitical environment and supply chain vulnerabilities. The leaders directed their ministers to hold the fourth India-Japan 2+2 Ministerial Meeting in Tokyo by the end of the year and welcomed agreement in principle on the UNICORN communication antenna project. They adopted a Joint Declaration on Economic Security Cooperation targeting semiconductors, critical minerals, clean energy, and pharmaceuticals, while pledging to oppose economic coercion and arbitrary export restrictions. In energy, the leaders launched the India-Japan Cooperative Biogas for Growth Initiative and agreed to cooperate on strategic petroleum reserves, clean ammonia, green hydrogen, and nuclear energy, alongside Japan supporting India's IEA membership.

When: 2026-10-02 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Narendra Modi, Sanae Takaichi · **Prelims:** The 16th India-Japan Annual Summit was held in New Delhi.; The India-Japan Cooperative Biogas for Growth Initiative aims to support 1,000 biogas and organic fertiliser plants.; The LUPEX mission is a joint lunar polar exploration project between India and Japan.

Why it matters — *Deepens bilateral defence manufacturing integration and maritime domain awareness under the Indo-Pacific strategy.; Secures critical mineral and semiconductor supply chains through joint economic security declarations.*

Static — The India-Japan Special Strategic and Global Partnership was formally established to elevate bilateral ties, encompassing comprehensive cooperation in economic, security, and strategic domains across the Indo-Pacific. The Quad security dialogue brings together India, Japan, the United States, and Australia to ensure a free, open, and inclusive Indo-Pacific region through regular summits and joint military exercises. The Mumbai-Ahmedabad High-Speed Rail project is India's first bullet train initiative, being executed with technical and financial assistance from Japan utilizing Shinkansen technology.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations, Defence

ddnews.gov.in: read the source

Economy

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Government Extends Remission of Duties and Taxes on Exported Products (RoDTEP) Scheme upto 31st December 2026

The Department of Commerce extended the Remission of Duties and Taxes on Exported Products (RoDTEP) scheme up to December 31, 2026, via Notification No. 41/2026-27. The extension was triggered by the scheduled expiry of the scheme at the end of September to prevent disruption and provide policy continuity. The core issue is helping Indian exporters recover un-refunded central, state, and local embedded taxes to remain competitive in volatile global markets. The scheme covers exports made by Domestic Tariff Area Units, Advance Authorisation Holders, Special Economic Zone Units, and Export Oriented Units. Existing RoDTEP refund rates, ranging from 0.3% to 3.9%, and value caps notified in Appendix 4R and Appendix 4RE continue unchanged. The budget allocation for the scheme was Rs 18,232 crore for 2025-26, with an allocation of Rs 10,000 crore for the current financial year. This short-term extension grants the government additional time to determine a longer-term framework for export-related duty and tax remission measures.

When: 31st December 2026 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Department of Commerce · **Prelims:** RoDTEP stands for Remission of Duties and Taxes on Exported Products.; Current refund rates under the scheme range from 0.3% to 3.9%.; The extension notification number is No. 41/2026-27 dated 30th September 2026.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Provides immediate financial continuity and relief to Indian exporters facing global trade uncertainties.; Maintains level playing field for domestic exporters against international competitors by neutralizing domestic tax burdens.*

Static — The RoDTEP scheme was introduced by the central government to replace the WTO-incompliant Merchandise Exports from India Scheme (MEIS). It operates as a mechanism to refund embedded, un-rebated central, state, and local duties and taxes that are otherwise not rebated under existing schemes. The scheme aims to boost India's export competitiveness by ensuring taxes are not exported, creating a level playing field globally.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Scheme, Act/Bill/Rules

PIB: read the source · free copy on english.mathrubhumi.com

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Cabinet approves Rs 84,084 crore ‘Samudra Manthan’ scheme to boost offshore oil and gas exploration

The Union Cabinet approved the Samudra Manthan National Offshore Exploration Scheme with a financial outlay of Rs 84,084 crore. The scheme is a central sector initiative of the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas and will be implemented through FY2030-31. The initiative aims to accelerate offshore oil and gas exploration, strengthen energy security, and enhance domestic production. It covers the entire offshore exploration value chain including seismic data acquisition, deepwater drilling, and common infrastructure development. The scheme provides for an integrated Oil and Gas Manufacturing and Services Zone along with digital programme management and capacity building. The government expects the initiative to facilitate reserve accretion of more than 600 Million Metric Tonnes of Oil Equivalent. The project is projected to generate large-scale employment, boost indigenous manufacturing, and attract substantial investments.

When: FY2030-31 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Union Cabinet, Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas · **Prelims:** Outlay of the scheme is Rs 84,084 crore.; Implementation timeline is through FY2030-31.; The scheme is a central sector initiative of the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Aims to achieve a reserve accretion of over 600 Million Metric Tonnes of Oil Equivalent (MMTOE).; Boosts indigenous manufacturing and employment under Make in India and Atmanirbhar Bharat.*

Static — Offshore oil and gas exploration in India is regulated under the petroleum laws and policies overseen by the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas. Upstream sector reforms in India include frameworks like the Open Acreage Licensing Policy (OALP) which allows companies to bid for exploration blocks at any time. The National Data Repository (NDR) serves as a centralised database to store, manage, and provide exploration and production data to prospective investors.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Scheme, Data/Stats

ddnews.gov.in: read the source · also reported by Times of India

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Cabinet approves Rs 1.27 lakh crore Semicon 2.0 to strengthen India’s semiconductor ecosystem

The Union Cabinet approved Semicon 2.0 with an outlay of Rs 1.27 lakh crore to strengthen India's semiconductor ecosystem. The policy aims to build on the initial momentum of the India Semiconductor Mission to establish domestic manufacturing capabilities. Global economic volatility, foreign fund outflows, high bond yields, and rising crude oil prices provided the broader market context. Asian shares fell on Friday as investors reacted to volatile bond and currency markets ahead of US jobs data. A widening US military buildup in the Gulf kept oil prices elevated, adding to global inflation risks. Domestic market benchmarks Sensex and Nifty ended lower for the fourth consecutive day due to negative investor sentiment. The funding and policy measures under Semicon 2.0 intend to scale up production and secure supply chains for the future.

When: 2026-10-02 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Union Cabinet · **Prelims:** Semicon 2.0 outlay is Rs 1.27 lakh crore.; BSE Sensex dropped during the announcement week amid continuous foreign fund outflows.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Crucial for reducing India's heavy import dependence on critical microchips.; Positions India as an emerging alternative hub in global electronics and semiconductor supply chains.*

Static — Semiconductor manufacturing involves complex fabrication plants, requiring high capital investment, cleanroom environments, and stable supplies of ultrapure water and power. India Semiconductor Mission (ISM) was established as a specialized business division under Digital India Corporation to drive electronics manufacturing. The government initially launched a Rs 76,000 crore production-linked incentive (PLI) scheme for semiconductors and display manufacturing ecosystems.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Governance & Policy, Science & Technology · Prelims angle: Data/Stats

ddnews.gov.in: read the source

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

India goes FTA shopping at G20 as Piyush Goyal works the room with a cart full of trade deals

The active trade negotiations conducted by the Commerce Minister during the G20 meeting put the topic in the news. Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal is negotiating multiple trade deals, including interim pacts and comprehensive economic partnerships, at the G20 meeting. Talks with the US include an interim pact and finalizing issues for a broader agreement. Discussions with Canada aim to conclude a Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement by the end of 2026. Existing trade agreements with the UK and Australia are also under review for their implementation and effectiveness.

When: 2026 · **Where:** G20 meeting · **Who:** Piyush Goyal, Commerce Minister of India · **Prelims:** Piyush Goyal is India's Commerce Minister.; Trade talks with Canada aim to conclude a CEPA by the end of 2026.; Existing trade agreements with the UK and Australia are under review.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Crucial for expanding India's export markets and integrating into global value chains.; Helps strengthen diplomatic and economic ties with major economies like the US, Canada, UK, and Australia.*

Static — Free Trade Agreements (FTAs) are treaties between two or more countries that facilitate trade by reducing or eliminating import tariffs and quotas. A Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA) goes beyond a standard FTA to include deeper economic cooperation, investments, and services. The G20 is an international forum for the governments and central bank governors from major advanced and emerging economies.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Economy, International Relations · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU

Economic Times: read the source

GS3 MAKE NOTES

PLI schemes attract over Rs 2.40 lakh crore investment, generate more than 14.15 lakh jobs: Government

The Government announced that Production Linked Incentive (PLI) schemes have attracted over Rs. 2.40 lakh crore in actual investments since their launch. The schemes have generated more than 14.15 lakh direct and indirect employment opportunities across 14 covered key sectors. Cumulative exports under the PLI schemes have crossed Rs. 15.2 lakh crore, reflecting India's increasing integration into global value chains. The PLI schemes have an approved financial outlay of Rs. 1.91 lakh crore and aim to enhance domestic manufacturing capabilities. The Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) serves as the nodal department for overall coordination and monitoring. Mobile phone production increased by 2.4 times, imports dropped by 77 percent, and 99.2 percent of phones used in India are now domestically made. Pharmaceutical sales crossed Rs. 3.64 lakh crore, enabling domestic manufacture of 1,931 products including 191 bulk drugs produced for the first time. High Efficiency Solar PV Modules attracted the highest cumulative investment of Rs. 64,873 crore among all sectors. Implementation is periodically reviewed by the Empowered Group of Secretaries chaired by the Cabinet Secretary and administrative ministries.

When: 2026-10-02 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) · **Prelims:** Total investments attracted under PLI schemes exceed Rs. 2.40 lakh crore.; Employment generated stands at more than 14.15 lakh direct and indirect jobs.; Total approved financial outlay for the 14 key sectors is Rs. 1.91 lakh crore.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the tangible progress and export growth resulting from industrial policy interventions in manufacturing.; Demonstrates import substitution success in critical sectors like mobile manufacturing, bulk drugs, and medical devices.*

Static — The Production Linked Incentive (PLI) scheme was introduced to provide financial incentives to domestic and international companies for manufacturing target products in India. The primary objectives of PLI schemes are to boost domestic manufacturing, attract foreign and domestic investments, enhance export competitiveness, and create large-scale employment. DPIIT acts as the nodal body for coordination, while individual line ministries and departments handle sector-specific implementation.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Scheme, Data/Stats

ddnews.gov.in: read the source

GS3 MAKE NOTES

RBI hikes repo rate by 25 basis points to 5.5%

The upcoming October monetary policy meeting of the RBI triggered this market poll and analyst projections. A Business Standard poll indicates that the RBI may increase the repo rate by 25 basis points during its October meeting. On Monday, the Reserve Bank of India's Monetary Policy Committee will hold important meetings. Analysts are anticipating a 25 basis points increase in the key interest rate, raising it to 5.50%. The surge in inflation is attributed to elevated crude oil costs and subpar agricultural production. Many economists advocate for a rate hike as a crucial measure to tackle ongoing inflation issues, with outcomes to be revealed on October 7. The hike comes after nearly three-and-a half years; monetary policy stance was changed to ‘calibrated tightening’ from ‘neutral’

When: October 2026 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Reserve Bank of India · **Prelims:** The poll was conducted by Business Standard.; The anticipated hike mentioned is 25 basis points.; The meeting in question is scheduled for October.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights market expectations regarding central bank policy actions.; Provides insights into how monetary authorities manage inflation and borrowing costs.*

Static — The Monetary Policy Committee is a statutory body constituted under Section 45ZB of the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934. It is entrusted with fixing the benchmark repo rate required to contain inflation within the specified target level. The committee comprises six members: three officials of the Reserve Bank of India and three external members appointed by the central government.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Governance & Policy, Environment & Ecology · Prelims angle: Data/Stats, Report/Index

Economic Times: read the source · also reported by Business Standard, BusinessLine, Telangana Today, Times Now

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

India’s Social Protection Coverage Rises to 65.3%; MoSPI Releases SDG Progress Report

MoSPI released a series of publications on Sustainable Development Goals, including the National Indicator Framework Progress Report 2026, marking Statistics Day. The 2026 framework comprises 277 national SDG indicators developed in consultation with central ministries, NITI Aayog, and UN agencies. The core report highlights that India's population covered by social protection systems increased from 22 per cent in 2016 to 65.3 per cent in 2026. Maternal Mortality Ratio declined from 122 per 100,000 live births in 2015-17 to 87 during 2022-24, while Sex Ratio at Birth improved to 918. The unemployment rate declined from 6.1 per cent in 2017-18 to 3.1 per cent in 2025. Installed renewable energy capacity expanded threefold from 64.04 watts per capita in 2014-15 to 193.36 watts per capita in 2025-26. Internet subscriptions grew substantially from 302.36 million in 2015 to 969.10 million in 2025. The area of Ramsar sites as a proportion of total wetland area increased from 4.15 per cent in 2016 to 8.66 per cent in 2026.

When: 2026-10-02 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation · **Prelims:** Social protection coverage increased from 22 per cent in 2016 to 65.3 per cent in 2026.; Maternal Mortality Ratio declined from 122 during 2015-17 to 87 during 2022-24.; Unemployment rate declined from 6.1 per cent in 2017-18 to 3.1 per cent in 2025.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Provides empirical data for evaluating the effectiveness of central welfare schemes and policy interventions.; Tracks critical socio-economic parameters like maternal mortality, unemployment, and renewable energy adoption for inclusive growth assessment.*

Static — The Sustainable Development Goals are a collection of 17 global goals designed to be a blueprint to achieve a better and more sustainable future for all, set up by the United Nations. The National Indicator Framework serves as the country's official statistical mechanism for monitoring national progress on the Sustainable Development Goals. The Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation is the nodal ministry in India responsible for coordinating the monitoring of SDG indicators.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Economy · Prelims angle: Report/Index

ddnews.gov.in: read the source

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Rs 2.3L crore unused in five years due to weak budget plan: CAG

A CAG report on State Finances for 2024-25 revealed that over Rs 2.36 lakh crore remained unspent or surrendered across departments over five years. The persistent under-utilisation of funds highlights weaknesses in budget formulation, unrealistic budgeting, and poor implementation capacity by the state. Savings or unutilised funds ranged between 17.70 per cent and 25.98 per cent of the total budget provision between 2020-21 and 2024-25. In the 2024-25 fiscal year, against a total budget provision of Rs 2.88 lakh crore, actual expenditure was only Rs 2.32 lakh crore, leaving Rs 56,156 crore unspent. Out of the unspent amount in 2024-25, a sum of Rs 2,815.91 crore was not even surrendered by the concerned departments. The unspent balance stood at Rs 39,596 crore in 2021-22, rose to Rs 39,596 crore in 2022-23, and increased further to Rs 59,856 crore in 2023-24. The audit noted that such vast deviations point to a failure in assessing actual fund requirements, monitoring, and executing public resources efficiently.

When: 2020-21 to 2024-25 · **Where:** Bhubaneswar · **Who:** Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) · **Prelims:** More than Rs 2.36 lakh crore remained unspent or surrendered across departments over five years.; In 2024-25, the state utilised Rs 2.32 lakh crore out of a total budget provision of Rs 2.88 lakh crore.; In 2024-25, an amount of Rs 2,815.91 crore was not surrendered by the departments.

Why it matters — *Highlights systemic weaknesses in state budget formulation, forecasting, and implementation capacity.; Exposes inefficiencies in public resource management where substantial capital remains locked or unutilised instead of aiding development.*

Static — The Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) is established under Article 148 of the Constitution of India as an independent authority heading the Indian Audit and Accounts Department. The CAG is appointed by the President of India by warrant under his hand and seal, and holds office for a term of 6 years or up to the age of 65 years, whichever is earlier. The CAG can be removed from office only on the same grounds and in the same manner as a judge of the Supreme Court of India.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Data/Stats

newindianexpress.com: read the source

Environment & Ecology

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

Centre to resume appraising post facto green clearance cases after top court ruling

The Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change ordered the resumption of processing pending post facto environmental clearance proposals following a Supreme Court judgment in Vanashakti v. Union of India. Post facto environmental clearance is approval granted after a project has already commenced work, expanded, or modernised without obtaining prior legal clearance. The Centre introduced a one-time six-month amnesty window in 2017 for violation cases under the Environment Impact Assessment Notification of 2006 to bring unauthorized projects under scrutiny. In 2021, the Ministry issued an Office Memorandum establishing a standard operating procedure for violations, converting the one-time amnesty window into a continuing regularisation route. The Supreme Court struck down the 2021 Office Memorandum in May 2025 calling it illegal, but later recalled this order on a review petition by CREDAI. A Bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymala Bagchi and Vipul M Pancholi ruled on July 29, 2026, quashing the 2021 OM while protecting past approvals and directing pending applications to be taken to their logical conclusion.

When: 2026-07-29 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change, Supreme Court of India, Vanashakti · **Prelims:** The 2017 amnesty was a one-time six-month window for violations cases under the EIA Notification, 2006.; The Supreme Court Bench on July 29, 2026 was led by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant.; The Ministry issued its implementation direction to appraisal bodies on September 30, 2026.

Why it matters — *It clarifies the legal status of pending industrial and infrastructure projects that were stalled due to litigation.; It upholds the principle that prior environmental clearance under the EIA notification is mandatory unless formally amended.*

Static — Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA) is a statutory process under the Environment (Protection) Act, 1986, designed to predict and mitigate a project's environmental effects prior to approval. Category A projects are appraised centrally by the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change through an Expert Appraisal Committee. Category B projects are appraised at the state level by the State Environment Impact Assessment Authority alongside a State Expert Appraisal Committee.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Environment & Ecology, Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

civilsdaily.com: read the source

Science & Technology

GS3 MAKE NOTES

CSIR-CCMB develops India-specific tool to predict Sickle Cell severity

Scientists at CSIR-CCMB developed an India-specific disease severity score for sickle cell anaemia on October 2, 2026. The tool was built using clinical data from 171 Indian children aged up to 18 years at Government Medical College and Hospital, Nagpur. International tools like the Paediatric Severity Score match Indian clinical assessments in only about 67 percent of cases. The new models are named ISS1 and ISS2, addressing differences between Indian and Western or African clinical disease patterns. ISS1 improved clinical assessment accuracy to nearly 83 per cent using laboratory measurements. ISS2 achieved about 85 per cent concordance by using observable clinical indicators instead of lab tests. ISS2 successfully identified all patients categorized under the mild disease group. The development is part of the broader CSIR-Sickle Cell Anaemia Mission which also features a validated PCR molecular test. The tools require further validation across larger and more diverse populations before widespread clinical adoption.

When: 2 October 2026 · **Where:** Nagpur · **Who:** CSIR-Centre for Cellular and Molecular Biology · **Prelims:** The tool was developed by CSIR-CCMB using data from 171 Indian children.; ISS1 stands for India-specific Severity Score and achieves 83 per cent assessment accuracy.; ISS2 uses observable clinical indicators and achieves about 85 per cent concordance.

Why it matters — *Provides accurate prognostic assessments tailored to the genetic and clinical profile of Indian patients.; ISS2 eliminates reliance on extensive laboratory investigations by depending on observable clinical indicators.*

Static — Sickle cell anaemia is an inherited blood disorder caused by abnormal haemoglobin, leading to anaemia and painful organ complications. CSIR-CCMB is a premier research laboratory functioning under the Council of Scientific and Industrial Research in India. Hydroxyurea is a standard medicine prescribed in sickle cell disease management to reduce complications.

Syllabus: GS3: Science & Technology

The Hindu: read the source · *free copy on gktoday.in*

Defence

GS3 MAKE NOTES

DRDO Successfully Conducts Maiden Flight-Test of ‘Kusha’ Long-Range Air Defence Missile

The DRDO successfully conducted the maiden flight-test of the Kusha long-range air defence missile system. The test was carried out to evaluate the new indigenous system designed to protect against aerial threats. Project Kusha aims to provide multi-layered defence capabilities comparable to advanced international systems. The missile system is developed by the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO). Further tests and development trials are scheduled to refine the system before operational induction.

When: 2026-10-02 · **Where:** India · **Who:** DRDO · **Prelims:** The missile system is named Kusha.; The developing organisation is DRDO.; The test was a maiden flight-test of a long-range air defence missile.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Boosts India's indigenous defence manufacturing and self-reliance in critical military technologies.; Enhances national security by providing a robust shield against advanced aerial threats.*

Static — DRDO is the premier agency under the Department of Defence Research and Development in Ministry of Defence, Government of India. It was formed in 1958 by amalgamating the Technical Development Establishment and the Directorate of Technical Development & Production with the Defence Science Organisation. DRDO's mandate includes designing and developing cutting-edge indigenous defence systems and technologies for the Indian Armed Forces.

Syllabus: GS3: Defence, Science & Technology

ddnews.gov.in: read the source

PRELIMS FACTS

Concrete developments worth a quick read: exercises, pacts, Acts, approvals, schemes, species, verdicts.

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY REPORT/INDEX SPECIES QUICK READ

Wayanad vulture survey records 65 birds

A two-day vulture survey in the Wayanad Wildlife Sanctuary recorded a total of 65 individual birds. The recorded population comprises 54 White-rumped Vultures and 11 Red-headed Vultures. The survey highlights Wayanad's continued significance as Keralam's only known vulture habitat. The exercise was jointly conducted by the Forest Department, Wayanad Wildlife Division, WWF-India, and the Hume Centre for Ecology and Wildlife Biology.

The Hindu: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION DAY/OBSERVANCE SCHEME QUICK READ

2.42 Lakh Special Gram Sabhas Across India Put Citizen-Centric Initiatives at the Heart of Grassroots Discussions on Gandhi Jayanti

More than 2.42 lakh special gram sabhas were held across India on Gandhi Jayanti to discuss transformative governance reforms. The meetings were organized to launch the People's Plan Campaign 2026-27, titled Sabki Yojana Sabka Vikas. The core issue focused on enabling rural citizens to directly participate in local development planning and government initiatives. Deliberations covered Central Finance Commission grants, own-source revenue, land rights, livelihoods, drinking water, and sanitation.

PIB: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY SPECIES PLACE IN NEWS QUICK READ

Buxa Tiger Reserve

Union Minister for Environment, Forest and Climate Change and the West Bengal Chief Minister released the first tigress into Buxa Tiger Reserve. The tigress was translocated from Bihar’s Valmiki Tiger Reserve to mark Wildlife Week 2026. Buxa faced a local tiger decline previously due to habitat fragmentation, high biotic pressure, and prey depletion.

Insights on India: source

SOCIAL JUSTICE & WELFARE SCHEME DAY/OBSERVANCE QUICK READ

Union Minister Dr. Virendra Kumar And Shri B. L. Verma Distribute 662 Aids, Assistive Devices Costing Over Rs. 10 Lakh Distributed To 114 Senior Citizens In Delhi-NCR Under Rashtriya Vayoshri Yojana

Union Ministers distributed 662 aids and assistive devices worth over Rs. 10 lakh to 114 senior citizens in Delhi-NCR under the Rashtriya Vayoshri Yojana.

PIB: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION REPORT/INDEX QUICK READ

Election Commission's Special Drive To Enrol Left-Out Voters Where SIR Is Over

The Election Commission of India ordered a special drive across districts in 20 states to enrol left-out and eligible young or first-time voters. Tamil Nadu Chief Electoral Officer Archana Patnaik directed district authorities to implement the continuous updation process following ECI instructions. The core issue focuses on ensuring no eligible citizen is left off the electoral rolls following the conclusion of the SIR phase.

NDTV: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | SCHEME | QUICK READ

Tamil Nadu CM Vijay launches Vettri Payanam scheme, expanding no-fare bus travel for women

Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay launched the expanded Vettri Payanam scheme at the Koyambedu bus terminus for free bus travel. Women and transgender persons can now travel free of cost in government buses across Tamil Nadu under the expanded initiative. The scheme expansion aims to widen access to free public transport for students, working women, and citizens visiting hospitals.

newindianexpress.com: source

GEOGRAPHY | REPORT/INDEX | PLACE IN NEWS | QUICK READ

Government of India, in consultation with UT of Ladakh, identify 28 places/features, located in the UT of Ladakh, by standard place and feature names on the official map of Survey of India (SoI)

The Government of India, in consultation with the Union Territory of Ladakh, has identified 28 places and features in Ladakh. These features are now recognized by standard place and feature names on the official map of the Survey of India. The formal identification aims to facilitate accurate recognition of these geographical features. It also seeks to create better public awareness regarding these locations.

PIB: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION | ACT/BILL/RULES | APPOINTMENT | QUICK READ

Rules framed to standardise appointment of heads, members of various tribunals

The government has introduced new rules for the National Tribunals Commission to standardise recruitment, eligibility, and service conditions for tribunal posts. Issued by the Union law ministry on September 30, the rules will enable the commission to appoint chairpersons and members to 16 tribunals and appellate bodies. The rules establish a formal inquiry mechanism for misconduct complaints and prescribe uniform service conditions and remuneration.

The Hindu: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY | SPECIES | QUICK READ

Scientists have discovered a new species of tiny shark in the Indian Ocean

Researchers have identified the southeastern gentoo as a new penguin species, named Pygoscelis kerguelensis, after discovering hidden genetic differences. The discovery stems from an international team of 22 researchers analysing the genomes of 64 gentoo penguins from 10 breeding colonies. The core finding splits what was long considered a single gentoo species into four distinct species: northern, southern, eastern, and southeastern.

english.mathrubhumi.com: source

AGRICULTURE & ALLIED | QUICK READ

India and Netherlands Discuss Deepening Agricultural Cooperation

India and the Netherlands agreed to strengthen their agricultural partnership focusing on innovation, horticulture, and the seed sector. Union Agriculture and Farmers Welfare Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan held bilateral discussions with Dutch Agriculture Minister Silvio Erkens. The meeting reviewed the progress of 25 Centres of Excellence established in agriculture and horticulture sectors across several Indian states.

PIB: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS | AGREEMENT/MOU | QUICK READ

India, Bulgaria review bilateral ties; push for early India-EU FTA

India and Bulgaria called for the early implementation of the India-European Union Free Trade Agreement (FTA) to boost economic ties. The push for the trade pact happened during the India-Bulgaria Foreign Office Consultations (FOC). The FOC was co-chaired by Secretary (West) Sibi George and Bulgaria's Deputy Minister of Foreign Affairs Christo Polendakov. Both nations comprehensively reviewed bilateral cooperation covering defence, artificial intelligence, trade, science, technology, and space.

Economic Times: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY | SCHEME | PLACE IN NEWS | QUICK READ

Mumbais Jawahar Dweep Becomes Indias First Plastic-free Oil Terminal

Mumbai Port Authority declared the Jawahar Dweep Marine Oil Terminal completely plastic-free on 2 October 2026. The declaration was made during the Swachhata Abhiyan 2026 celebrations held at Grey Gate, Indira Dock, in Mumbai. The initiative marks India's first instance of an oil terminal eliminating single-use plastics entirely. Jawahar Dweep, also known as Butcher Island, is an offshore facility located four kilometres off Mumbai's coast with five jetties.

PIB: source

SOCIAL JUSTICE & WELFARE QUICK READ

Madhya Pradesh–Karnataka Delegation of Yuva Sangam Phase VII Embarks on a Journey of Cultural Discovery and Youth Exchange

The Madhya Pradesh–Karnataka delegation of Yuva Sangam Phase VII embarked on a cultural and educational exchange journey. The initiative is organized to strengthen people-to-people connections and national integration among youth under the Ek Bharat Shreshtha Bharat programme. The School of Planning and Architecture (SPA), Bhopal serves as the nodal institute for the Madhya Pradesh delegation.

PIB: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY QUICK READ

Union Home Minister and Minister of Cooperation Shri Amit Shah to address Gopalak Sammelan in Bhopal and inaugurate State-Level Exhibition on Nyaya Sanhita

The event is scheduled for October 3, 2026, in Bhopal, Madhya Pradesh, to advance cooperative and dairy sector initiatives. Union Home Minister Shri Amit Shah will visit Bhopal to address the Gopalak Sammelan, inaugurate a Nyaya Sanhita exhibition, and launch major dairy and cooperative projects.

PIB: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AGREEMENT/MOU QUICK READ

India, Australia aim to expedite CECA, review ECTA progress to maximize duty-free access for Indian exporters

Trade ministers from India and Australia held high-level talks to review existing trade agreements and accelerate future economic pacts. India and Australia are looking to accelerate negotiations on their Comprehensive Economic Cooperation Agreement, with Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal and Australian Trade Minister Don Farrell discussing cooperation in pharmaceuticals, services, investment, agri-tech and critical minerals.

Economic Times: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY SCHEME QUICK READ

Delays prevented J&K from getting full central aid for Jal Jeevan Mission: CAG

The CAG reported that Jammu and Kashmir failed to receive full central assistance under the Jal Jeevan Mission due to funding utilisation delays and unfulfilled release conditions. The audit covering 2019-20 to 2023-24 highlighted that the institutional implementation mechanism in J&K was neither fully operational nor effective. Issues included shortfalls in District Water Sanitation Mission meetings, absence of a bottom-up approach, and failure to prepare district annual action plans.

tribuneindia.com: source

ECONOMY QUICK READ

Forex reserves plunge record $18.3 billion as RBI steps in to support rupee

India's foreign exchange reserves plummeted by a record $18.343 billion to $747.557 billion during the week ended September 25. The sharp contraction occurred as the Reserve Bank of India intervened in the market to support the weakening rupee. Foreign currency assets contracted by $15.57 billion to $615.411 billion, forming the major portion of the overall reserves decline.

Mint: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY SCHEME QUICK READ

NCR Industry Pollution Subsidy: Centre Likely To Roll Out Rs. 600 Crore Scheme

The Union government is likely to launch a Rs 600 crore scheme called Swacch Pawan Neel Gagan for polluting industries in the NCR. The scheme offers a 30 to 40 percent subsidy to industries for installing air pollution control devices, with units paying the remainder. The proposed plan has already received Expenditure Finance Committee approval and is currently awaiting final clearances.

outlookindia.com: source

ECONOMY REPORT/INDEX QUICK READ

Telangana Leads India in Data Centre Policy Attractiveness

Telangana offers India’s most attractive state policy package for data centres, backed by electricity and regulatory incentives according to S&P Global’s India Forward report. Maharashtra and Uttar Pradesh also rank among top leaders, providing balanced support across power, infrastructure, capital, and regulatory requirements. Gujarat stands out for electricity incentives and measures that simplify business operations, while Andhra Pradesh leads overall in land and capital benefits.

freepressjournal.in: source

DEFENCE EXERCISE QUICK READ

India-Uzbekistan joint military exercise reinforces military cooperation, improves interoperability

The 7th edition of India-Uzbekistan joint military exercise Dustlik culminated at the Gurumsaray Field Training Area in Namangan, Uzbekistan. The exercise was held as part of the annual bilateral defence engagement between India and Uzbekistan. It aimed to enhance interoperability and combined capabilities to conduct joint counter-terrorism operations in semi-mountainous terrain. The 60-member Indian contingent included 45 personnel from the Mahar Regiment (Army) and 15 from the Air Force.

ddnews.gov.in: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION JUDGMENT ACT/BILL/RULES QUICK READ

Supreme Court sets aside Ooty resort auction, stresses strict compliance under SARFAESI Act

The Supreme Court held that an auction sale under the SARFAESI Act is illegal if statutory procedures are not strictly followed. A bench of Justices P S Narasimha and Alok Aradhe set aside a 2013 Madras High Court judgment upholding the sale of 'The Fernhill' resort in Ooty. The court found multiple procedural violations by lenders, including receiving bids during a period when the Debt Recovery Tribunal had restrained proceedings.

deccanherald.com: source

ECONOMY QUICK READ

Fatehpur's Malwan peda lands Italy export order, eyes GI tag

Fatehpur's traditional sweet, Malwan peda, has secured an international export order to supply 200 kg to Italian food joint Domenico Percoco. The export order was achieved after local traders showcased the sweet at the UP International Trade Show under the One District One Product scheme. The core issue highlights how targeted state trade platforms help traditional regional delicacies scale up to international markets.

timesofindia.indiatimes.com: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS APPOINTMENT QUICK READ

Bangladesh Foreign Minister Khalilur Rahman elected President of 81st UN General Assembly; Jaishankar extends congratulations

Bangladesh Foreign Minister Dr. Khalilur Rahman was elected President of the 81st Session of the United Nations General Assembly on Tuesday. He defeated Cypriot diplomat Andreas Kakouris in a closely contested vote held among the 193-member UN body. Rahman secured 99 votes against Kakouris' 91 votes in the election. He will assume office in September when the 81st session begins, succeeding current President Annalena Baerbock.

ddnews.gov.in: source

DEFENCE SPECIES EXERCISE QUICK READ

India-Mongolia Exercise Nomadic Elephant 2026 Highlights Combat Medical Preparedness

The commencement and highlights of Exercise Nomadic Elephant 2026 put it in the news. Exercise Nomadic Elephant 2026 is a joint military exercise between India and Mongolia focusing on combat medical preparedness.

SSBCrack: source

EDITORIAL WATCH

What the opinion pages argued: two or three lines each.

GS3 India's Model BIT — A Decade Later, Amid Changes

The Union Budget 2025-26 announced that India's Model Bilateral Investment Treaty would be revamped and made more investor-friendly. India turned cautious on investment treaties after the 2011 White Industries award against India and worries over investor-state dispute settlement. The 2015 Model narrowed investment definitions, kept regulatory exceptions, and required investors to exhaust local remedies for five years before arbitration. Since 2015, India concluded newer agreements with the UAE, Uzbekistan, and Israel, cutting the local remedies period to three years.

The Hindu

GS3 We have a model investment treaty. And are losing billions because of it

India's bilateral investment treaties in force dropped significantly from 73 in 2015 to just eight by 2021 following the strict 2016 Model BIT. The 2016 Model BIT requires foreign investors to litigate in local courts for five years before accessing international arbitration, causing severe delays. Global norms typically require only a three to six month consultation period to settle disputes, making India's terms extremely restrictive.

civilsdaily.com

GS1 GS3 Needed: A Super El Nino Abhiyan

Global scientific bodies like the WMO and NOAA express high confidence that a strong to very strong El Niño will continue into spring 2027. This supersized El Niño threatens massive economic blows and could be the worst event in a millennium based on 1,000-year coral-core climate records. The author argues that Pacific El Niño events disrupt Indian monsoon winds, historically causing severe droughts in years like 1972, 2002, and 2009.

msn.com

GS3 Industry is growing, but isn't creating jobs

Formal factories are growing steadily, but they remain too small a part of the economy to absorb India's massive workforce. Invested capital has risen consistently, yet output per worker and wage growth have lagged behind net profits. Nearly three in four non-farm workers continue to toil in informal-sector enterprises, highlighting a massive formal sector employment shortfall. Organised manufacturing is dominated by small firms, while factories fail to absorb millions entering the labour force or leaving farming.

civilsdaily.com

GS3 To cash in on next tech boom, India needs the right chips

India's semiconductor push has successfully established assembly capacity, but it still lacks a strong presence in the high-value design-led segments. The author argues that the upcoming Union Budget should fund design and inference chips instead of focusing solely on low-margin packaging plants. Advanced packaging offers gross margins of 25-35%, whereas IP-owning chip design yields significantly higher gross margins of 50-70%. To capture future tech growth, the author proposes creating at least two sovereign AI inference chip programmes backed by guaranteed government offtake.

civilsdaily.com

GS2 ECI row does a disservice to the right to vote

The author argues that the political row surrounding the Election Commission of India and the Special Intensive Revision harms the sacred right to vote. The ruling dispensation defends Kumar while the INDIA bloc targets him through a vote chori campaign. Kumar is taking corrective action by restoring the original Form 6 in states where the SIR exercise is finished. A Supreme Court judge recently stressed that the ECI must remain manifestly independent, requiring a consensus to bar post-retirement political roles.

tribuneindia.com

GS3 Time for a heat pump mission

SpaceX's Starship reached Earth orbit for the first time on September 28, 2026, during its 14th test flight. The mission marked the first deployment of 26 new next-generation Starlink internet satellites into the constellation. Despite engine failure and a reduced schedule of two orbits instead of six, the flight was considered a success. Starship aims to be a fully and rapidly reusable transport system that slashes the cost of spaceflight.

msn.com

GS2 For constituting poll body, a lesson from the UN

Recent controversies over the Election Commission and a Supreme Court split verdict highlight the need to protect public trust in India's electoral system. Article 324 of the Constitution vests the superintendence and conduct of elections in the Election Commission of India comprising the CEC and other ECs. For 75 years the executive made these appointments without a specific parliamentary law until the Supreme Court intervened in March 2023.

ForumIAS

GS3 A modest repo rate hike will be in order

The piece appeared as an opinion commentary on the appropriate monetary policy stance amid global financial conditions. The editorial suggests that the Reserve Bank of India's Monetary Policy Committee should implement a modest repo rate hike to address inflationary pressures and global tightening trends. The MPC cannot disregard the broader tightening bias globally. Also, a hike will help RBI stay ahead of the inflation curve

BusinessLine

GS3 Floods, Droughts, and Inflation Expectations

The recurring impact of extreme weather events on food prices and monetary policy management brought the issue into focus. The editorial discusses how extreme weather events like floods and droughts impact agricultural output and fuel inflation expectations.

EPW

GS2 Trump-Xi bonhomie is temporary. Why the US and China can't build a G2

US President Donald Trump hosted Chinese President Xi Jinping in Washington with a military flyover, troops display, and a dinner with tech executives. This visit followed Trump's trip to Beijing earlier in the year where Xi hosted him at the Great Hall of the People and Zhongnanhai. The meetings yielded little consensus on tariffs, trade, and Taiwan, with tariffs extended by just two months instead of two years. China reiterated promises to buy $17 billion in US agricultural products annually and 200 Boeing aircraft.

ThePrint

GS2 GS3 From Gram Swaraj to SVAMITVA: unlocking the mystery of capital in Madhya Pradesh

The editorial highlights how proper property records under SVAMITVA help realize Gram Swaraj and unlock rural capital in Madhya Pradesh. Madhya Pradesh is implementing the SVAMITVA scheme to establish clear spatial and documentary records of rural residential properties, thereby reducing disputes and formalizing rural assets.

The Hindu

GS2 GS3 CBAM can help India build a greener, competitive export sector

The definitive phase of the European Union's Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism commenced on January 1, covering six carbon-intensive sectors. CBAM requires importers to account for embedded emissions and surrender certificates linked to the EU Emissions Trading System carbon price. India's immediate exposure concerns iron and steel and aluminium, but the EU plans to extend the mechanism to downstream products, organic chemicals, and polymers. Measurement, reporting, verification, and certification impose disproportionate costs on small and medium exporters even before any carbon levy.

Economic Times

GS2 Obstacle race: On Special Intensive Revision exercise

The Special Intensive Revision exercise came into focus due to concerns over its impact on voter registration and potential disenfranchisement. The editorial critiques the Special Intensive Revision exercise for potentially threatening universal adult franchise and creating obstacles for voters. The SIR is threatening universal adult franchise

The Hindu

GS3 Rescue act: On tiger reintroduction in West Bengal's Buxa

The ongoing conservation efforts and discussions regarding tiger reintroduction in Buxa put the reserve in the news. The editorial discusses the ecological imperatives and challenges involved in the reintroduction of tigers in West Bengal's Buxa Tiger Reserve. Preventing ecological degradation is the way to protect wildlife

The Hindu

EXPLAINED

The concept behind the news, one or two lines each.

What is the 'Gem Granites' Veeramani POCSO Act case all about? The Goondas Act was invoked against Gem Granites owner R Veeramani and two others, Shanthi and Mahendra Simhan, who were arrested in a POCSO case. Preventive detention orders against the three accused were issued by the Chennai City Police Commissioner following allegations of sexual offences against minors.

The Hindu

Mint Explainer | How the GOBARdhan scheme helps in achieving energy security and transition The explainer highlights the role of the GOBARdhan scheme in driving India's energy transition and security. The GOBARdhan scheme converts organic waste and cattle dung into biogas and organic manure to boost rural energy security.

Mint

What explains the increasing contribution of import-linked taxation to India's GST revenues? Examine whether such revenue buoyancy can be sustained over the long term. What measures can deepen domestic revenue mobilisation without increasing the tax burden? The article discusses the increasing contribution of import-linked taxation to India's GST revenues and examines its long-term sustainability. It questions whether headline GST buoyancy reflects strong domestic economic activity or external import dynamics. Drivers of import-linked GST include import values, exchange-rate movements, global commodity prices, and reliance on imported inputs.

Insights on India

Indian official attends SCO event in Pakistan: 5 broad takeaways An Indian official participated in an SCO event held in Pakistan, generating 5 broad takeaways for regional diplomacy. An Indian official attended a Shanghai Cooperation Organisation event hosted in Pakistan, marking a notable diplomatic engagement.

Indian Express

Riding Elon Musk's Falcon 9 to space, how a Made-in-Gujarat satellite will help India The successful launch of the Gujarat-built satellite aboard SpaceX's Falcon 9 put it in the news. A Made-in-Gujarat satellite was launched into space utilizing Elon Musk's Falcon 9 rocket.

Indian Express

Explained: The 2008 Ahmedabad blast and the terrorist whose death sentence was stayed by Supreme Court The Supreme Court paused the execution of the death penalty awarded to Indian Mujahideen terrorist Ahmed Bawa alias Abbu Abubakar Barelvi. The pause came on a plea filed by the convict challenging a Gujarat High Court verdict that upheld the death sentence.

indiatoday.in

Knowledge Nugget | Why is sea level rise a growing global threat? Published as a Knowledge Nugget for UPSC aspirants to understand the dimensions of sea level rise. An explainer detailing the causes and global threats associated with accelerating sea level rise.

Indian Express

How accurate is Bengaluru's AI traffic enforcement? Growing public debate around the shortcomings and error rates of AI-based smart policing systems. An explainer examining the working, accuracy, challan generation, and dispute mechanisms of Bengaluru Traffic Police's AI-driven ITMS.
The Hindu

From giraffes to pandas: The millennia-long history of animal diplomacy The historical evolution of animal diplomacy came into focus through recent discussions on how nations use wildlife exchanges in geopolitics. Animal diplomacy refers to the millennia-long practice of gifting or loaning live exotic animals between states to build diplomatic relations and exercise soft power.
Indian Express

How was Gandhi's portrait chosen to appear on rupee notes? The origin of Gandhi's portrait on currency notes is often revisited around significant national dates like Gandhi Jayanti. This explainer details the historical process and background behind how Mahatma Gandhi's portrait was selected to appear on Indian rupee banknotes.
Indian Express

It Took Nearly 50 Years For Mahatma Gandhi To Become Face Of The Indian Rupee. Here's The Story Independent India initially decided not to feature Mahatma Gandhi on its first banknotes, opting instead for the Lion Capital at Sarnath in 1949. During the early decades, Indian currency featured diverse themes including wildlife, art, agriculture, infrastructure, and scientific progress like the Aryabhatta satellite.
news18.com

Mumbai airport Terminal 1 to shut for 4 years: What does it mean for flyers? Mumbai's Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj International Airport Terminal 1 will shut for flight operations from October 25, 2026, until 2029-30. The closure is for a large-scale demolition and reconstruction project to replace the ageing 84-year-old terminal with a modern facility.
businesstoday.in

ALSO IN THE NEWS

Reactions, previews and smaller stories: one line each.

- India's Green Energy Grid, Battery Storage Scheme Will Give Big Dividends: UN Climate Chief (Environment & Ecology) NDTV
- GST Council likely to consider allowing investigating agencies, police to use NATGRID to access GST data (Economy) BusinessLine
- FCNR inflows cushion rupee, BoP; FII flows crucial for sustained external stability: Report (Economy) Economic Times
- PM Modi has 'good ideas' for settlement of Ukraine conflict: Putin (International Relations) Times of India
- CAQM Reviews Enforcement Status Across NCR; 197 Inspections Conducted in 17 Days (Environment & Ecology) PIB
- Prime Minister's Employment Generation Programme: Empowering Entrepreneurs and Driving Inclusive Growth Across India (Economy) PIB
- NITI Aayog organises National Workshop on SDG Budgeting in Kolkata under the State Support Mission, in collaboration with the Government of West Bengal and UNDP (Governance & Policy) PIB
- Vande Bharat crosses Chenab, Anji bridges at 100 kmph as Katra-Banihal train speed limit raised (Infrastructure & Energy) NDTV
- Andhra CM, Union FM lay foundation for Rs. 1 lakh-crore global horticulture hub at Madanapalle (Agriculture & Allied) BusinessLine
- APEDA Facilitates FPO-led Export of Frozen Food Products from Haryana to Canada (Economy) PIB
- The GOBARdhan Scheme (Environment & Ecology) Insights on India
- Forest dept. clears natural elephant passages in Chinnakkanal in Keralam (Environment & Ecology) The Hindu
- Multiple Indian payloads launched by Space X's Falcon 9 (Science & Technology) The Hindu
- Keralam Chief Minister promises separate housing scheme for SC/ST families (Social Justice & Welfare) The Hindu
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COVERAGE CHECK

Items — 21 must-know, 24 Prelims facts, 49 in the news, 15 editorials, 12 explainers.

Syllabus areas in the cards — Economy (11), Polity & Constitution (10), International Relations (7), Environment & Ecology (6), Defence (3), Governance & Policy (3), Social Justice & Welfare (2), Science & Technology (1), Geography (1), Agriculture & Allied (1). **Nothing today in —** Health, Education, Infrastructure & Energy, Internal Security, Disaster Management, History, Art & Culture, Society, Ethics & Integrity.

Easy-miss watch — Marine & coastal (EEZ, UNCLOS, Blue Economy, deep sea): 4 · Digital Public Infrastructure & data governance: 2 · Political change in the neighbourhood: 1 · Appointments to constitutional / statutory / regulatory bodies: 2 · Defence-technology cooperation agreements: 2

Full text — 51 of 72 items were read in full from a free copy; the rest are summarised from the outlets' reports. Subscriber-only sites are never opened.

Sources in the cards — The Hindu 10, ddnews.gov.in 9, PIB 8, Economic Times 6, Indian Express 5, civilsdaily.com 4, Hindustan Times 2, newindianexpress.com 2, Insights on India 2, tribuneindia.com 2, Mint 2, msn.com 2, keralakaumudi.com 1, Lawtext 1

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